

14The Word became flesh and made His dwelling among us.^a We have seen His glory, the glory of the one and only Son^b from the Father, full of grace and truth.

15John testified concerning Him. He cried out, saying, “This is He of whom I said, ‘He who comes after me has surpassed me because He was before me.’”

16From His fullness we have all received grace upon grace. **17**For the law was given through Moses; grace and truth came through Jesus Christ. **18**No one has ever seen God, but the one and only Son, who is Himself God and^c is at the Father’s side,^d has made Him known.

The Mission of John the Baptist

Isaiah 40:1–5; Matthew 3:1–12; Mark 1:1–8; Luke 3:1–20

19And this was John’s testimony when the Jews of Jerusalem sent priests and Levites to ask him, “Who are you?” **20**He did not refuse to confess, but openly declared, “I am not the Christ.”

21“Then who are you?” they inquired. “Are you Elijah?”

He said, “I am not.”

“Are you the Prophet?”

He answered, “No.”

22So they said to him, “Who are you? We need an answer for those who sent us. What do you say about yourself?”

23John replied in the words of Isaiah the prophet:

“I am a voice of one calling in the wilderness,

‘Make straight the way for the Lord.’”^e

24Then the Pharisees who had been sent **25**asked him, “Why then do you baptize, if you are not the Christ, nor Elijah, nor the Prophet?”

26“I baptize with^f water,” John replied, “but among you stands One you do not know. **27**He is the One who comes after me, the straps of whose sandals I am not worthy to untie.”

28All this happened at Bethany beyond the Jordan, where John was baptizing.

^aOr *and tabernacled among us*

^bOr *the Only Begotten or the Unique One*

^cOr *but the only begotten God, who; BYZ and TR but the only begotten Son, who*

^dGreek *in the Father’s bosom*

^eIsaiah 40:3 (see also LXX)

^fOr *in; also in verse 31 and twice in 33*

Jesus the Lamb of God

Matthew 3:13–17; Mark 1:9–11; Luke 3:21–22

²⁹The next day John saw Jesus coming toward him and said, “Look, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world! ³⁰This is He of whom I said, ‘A man who comes after me has surpassed me because He was before me.’ ³¹I myself did not know Him, but the reason I came baptizing with water was that He might be revealed to Israel.”

³²Then John testified, “I saw the Spirit descending from heaven like a dove and resting on Him. ³³I myself did not know Him, but the One who sent me to baptize with water told me, ‘The man on whom you see the Spirit descend and rest is He who will baptize with the Holy Spirit.’ ³⁴I have seen and testified that this is the Son of God.”^a

The First Disciples

Matthew 4:18–22; Mark 1:16–20; Luke 5:1–11

³⁵The next day John was there again with two of his disciples. ³⁶When he saw Jesus walking by, he said, “Look, the Lamb of God!” ³⁷And when the two disciples heard him say this, they followed Jesus.

³⁸Jesus turned and saw them following. “What do you want?” He asked. They said to Him, “Rabbi” (which means Teacher), “where are You staying?”

³⁹“Come and see,” He replied. So they went and saw where He was staying, and spent that day with Him. It was about the tenth hour.^b

⁴⁰Andrew, Simon Peter’s brother, was one of the two who heard John’s testimony and followed Jesus. ⁴¹He first found his brother Simon and told him, “We have found the Messiah” (which is translated as Christ).

⁴²Andrew brought him to Jesus, who looked at him and said, “You are Simon son of John. You will be called Cephas” (which is translated as Peter).

Jesus Calls Philip and Nathanael

⁴³The next day Jesus decided to set out for Galilee. Finding Philip, He told him, “Follow Me.” ⁴⁴Now Philip was from Bethsaida, the same town as Andrew and Peter.

⁴⁵Philip found Nathanael and told him, “We have found the One Moses wrote about in the Law, the One the prophets foretold — Jesus of Nazareth, the son of Joseph.”

⁴⁶“Can anything good come from Nazareth?” Nathanael asked. “Come and see,” said Philip.

^aSBL *the Chosen One of God*

^bThat is, about four in the afternoon

be born again.’⁸ The wind blows where it wishes. You hear its sound, but you do not know where it comes from or where it is going. So it is with everyone born of the Spirit.”

⁹“How can this be?” Nicodemus asked.

¹⁰ “You are Israel’s teacher,” said Jesus, “and you do not understand these things? ¹¹ Truly, truly, I tell you, we speak of what we know, and we testify to what we have seen, and yet you people do not accept our testimony.

¹² If I have told you about earthly things and you do not believe, how will you believe if I tell you about heavenly things? ¹³ No one has ascended into heaven except the One who descended from heaven— the Son of Man.^a ¹⁴ Just as Moses lifted up the snake in the wilderness, so the Son of Man must be lifted up, ¹⁵ that everyone who believes in Him may have eternal life.^b

¹⁶ For God so loved the world that He gave His one and only^c Son, that everyone who believes in Him shall not perish but have eternal life. ¹⁷ For God did not send His Son into the world to condemn the world, but to save the world through Him. ¹⁸ Whoever believes in Him is not condemned, but whoever does not believe has already been condemned, because he has not believed in the name of God’s one and only Son.

¹⁹ And this is the verdict: The Light has come into the world, but men loved the darkness rather than the Light because their deeds were evil. ²⁰ Everyone who does evil hates the Light, and does not come into the Light for fear that his deeds will be exposed. ²¹ But whoever practices the truth comes into the Light, so that it may be seen clearly that what he has done has been accomplished in God.”^d

John’s Testimony about Jesus

²² After this, Jesus and His disciples went into the Judean countryside, where He spent some time with them and baptized.

²³ Now John was also baptizing at Aenon near Salim, because the water was plentiful there, and people kept coming to be baptized. ²⁴ (For John had not yet been thrown into prison.)

²⁵ Then a dispute arose between John’s disciples and a certain Jew^e over the issue of ceremonial washing. ²⁶ So John’s disciples came to him and

^aBYZ and TR include *who is in heaven*.

^bOr *everyone who believes may have eternal life in Him*.

^cOr only begotten or *unique*; also in verse 18

^dSome translators close this quotation after verse 15.

^eTR and *the Jews*

⁵³Then the father realized that this was the very hour in which Jesus had told him, “**Your son will live.**” And he and all his household believed.

⁵⁴This was now the second sign that Jesus performed after coming from Judea into Galilee.

The Pool of Bethesda

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¹Some time later there was a feast of the Jews, and Jesus went up to Jerusalem.

²Now there is in Jerusalem near the Sheep Gate a pool with five covered colonnades, which in Hebrew^a is called Bethesda.^b ³On these walkways^c lay a great number of the sick, the blind, the lame, and the paralyzed.^d

⁵One man there had been an invalid for thirty-eight years. ⁶When Jesus saw him lying there and realized that he had spent a long time in this condition, He asked him, “**Do you want to get well?**”

⁷“Sir,” the invalid replied, “I have no one to help me into the pool when the water is stirred. While I am on my way, someone else goes in before me.”

⁸Then Jesus told him, “**Get up, pick up your mat, and walk.**”

⁹Immediately the man was made well, and he picked up his mat and began to walk.

Now this happened on the Sabbath day, ¹⁰so the Jews said to the man who had been healed, “This is the Sabbath! It is unlawful for you to carry your mat.”

¹¹But he answered, “The man who made me well told me, ‘**Pick up your mat and walk.**’”

¹²“Who is this man who told you to pick it up and walk?” they asked.

¹³But the man who was healed did not know who it was, for Jesus had slipped away while the crowd was there.

¹⁴Afterward, Jesus found the man at the temple and said to him, “**See, you have been made well. Stop sinning, or something worse may happen to you.**”

¹⁵And the man went away and told the Jews that it was Jesus who had made him well.

^bThat is, one in the afternoon

^aOr in Aramaic

^bNA, NE, and WH *Bethzatha*

^cLiterally *In these*

^dNE, BYZ, and TR include *awaiting the moving of the waters. 4 For from time to time an angel descended into the pool and stirred the water. As soon as it was stirred, the first to enter the pool would be healed of his disease.*